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Returning to the Nest

The trouble with having money to burn is that it usually comes after the fire has gone out.

— *A man at his retirement party*

Not surprisingly, most young adults look forward to financial independence. This desire to cut the umbilical cord of dependence upon their parents is also reinforced by their certainty that their parents are not going to support them forever. In fact, Charles Schwab's annual survey of "Teens and Money" found that 86 percent of teens expected their parents to stop supporting them before age twenty-five. However, the desire to cut the cord and the actual "ability" to cut the cord have created a very different reality for many young adults.

In a recent *Newsweek* poll, almost half of all college students graduating in 2006 said they were moving back into their parents' home after graduation. This boomerang effect is becoming increasingly common. In a number of instances, many "return to the nest" for financial reasons. Young adults may decide to come home because they cannot afford to be on their own or because they do not have marketable skills to find sustainable employment.

Even those who have been fortunate enough to find gainful employment sometimes end up having financial challenges